Arts, Culture and Heritage Policy

The Green Party will support the arts and cultural heritage sector to develop to its highest standard and be properly resourced. A Green government will collaborate with funders, the industry, and other stakeholders, including tangata whenua, who have the right to protect traditional and contemporary Māori art. We will nurture talent in our communities by providing educational opportunities in schools and communities and by expanding platforms for arts and cultural heritage.

Vision

Creative, cultural and heritage work is integrated within our communities in myriad innovative ways that empower people, spread happiness, and encourage intercultural appreciation and understanding.

Values and Principles

- *Honour Te Tiriti o Waitangi*: Revitalising and celebrating toi Māori, tikanga Māori and te reo Māori is key to ensuring a thriving arts industry. The Crown has a responsibility to ensure the protection and return of taonga, including Māori arts, culture, intellectual property and heritage sites. The Crown must support and contribute to but not determine the revitalisation of toi Māori, tikanga Māori and te reo Māori.
- *Ecological Wisdom*: The arts play a part in enabling the transition to a life-sustaining society by changing hearts and minds. Mātauranga Māori, as expressed through art and cultural practice, is inextricably linked to the natural world.
- *Social Responsibility*: The arts foster community and improve our daily well-being, empathy, equality and cultural diversity, as well as contributing economically.
- *Appropriate Decision-Making*: Those involved in arts and cultural heritage work must be involved in developing guidelines for funding. Local communities must be given the ability to protect places, buildings and heritage collections that are important to them historically and culturally. The tino rangatiratanga of hapū and iwi over their taonga must be affirmed, through Matike Mai mechanisms.
- *Non-Violence*: All art forms practised and recognised in Aotearoa New Zealand are included in this policy and their interconnectedness is acknowledged. The art forms of marginalised cultures and groups should be equitably supported.
- *Resilience:* Arts, culture and heritage are essential social infrastructure, not luxuries. The Government should help build their resilience in our communities and at professional levels.
- *Professional*: A vibrant and diverse professional arts sector contributes to all our lives, as well as the identity of Aotearoa New Zealand on the international stage.

Strategic Priorities

The Green Party's strategic goals include:

> *"People will be part of caring communities with a strong heritage fabric"*

Actions in this policy that will help achieve this include:

- Ensure cultural heritage infrastructure and funding provisions are sufficient to increase participation in community arts, provide arts and cultural heritage education, and support the professional arts to reach the highest standard. (1.2)
- Support and contribute to the revitalisation of toi Māori (2.1)
- Develop and resource the implementation of an ongoing arts education strategy from early childhood to tertiary level. (3.3.1)
- Developing a network of Art Spaces and heritage equivalents in every community that are accessible to all cultures and levels of ability, including programmes in prisons, and care and refuge spaces. (3.11)

Connected Policies

Providing platforms through Media to celebrate the arts is important for arts, culture and heritage to thrive. Ensuring sufficient income for those working in the arts, cultural and heritage sectors is part of our Livelihoods and Workforce Policies. The Crown's responsibility to ensure the protection and revitalisation of natural and other taonga is explored in our Biodiversity and Environmental Regeneration and Kaupapa Māori Policies.

Policy Positions

1. Resourcing the arts, culture and heritage sector

Issues

Inadequate resourcing of the arts, culture and heritage sector risks a downward spiral in which organisations close or cut back, long-running programmes disappear, inequities deepen, and the sector loses diversity and capacity it may not get back. The sector faces persistent structural problems with few full-time jobs, low pay, and an expectation that creative professionals will work for free or for 'exposure'. Burnout and financial stress are common. Toi Māori has long been structurally under-resourced relative to its cultural significance and the scale of its activity - especially considering language revitalisation, marae-based arts, intergenerational teaching, and community-driven practice.

Actions

1.1. Collaboratively establish effective systems of communication and coordination between all those involved in arts, culture, and heritage, including government ministries, funding agencies, local bodies, tangata whenua, and communities.

1.2. Ensure cultural heritage infrastructure and funding provisions are sufficient to increase participation in community arts, provide arts and cultural heritage education, and support the professional arts to reach the highest standard, including by:

1.2.1. Improving funding of local arts amenities, such as community galleries; and

1.2.2. Supporting the establishment of local arts trusts, especially where local arts are currently not well supported.

2. Ngā toi Māori

Issues

National strategy and funding systems were not designed for kaupapa that are relational, long-horizon and whakapapa-based, such as whare wānanga, customary arts, and iwi-driven arts infrastructure. They fail to uphold tino rangatiratanga or to represent the breadth and diversity of te ao Māori, instead encouraging simplified, commodified, or misappropriated works.

Actions

2.1. Support and contribute to the revitalisation of toi Māori, including by:

2.1.1. Establishing the legal ownership by tangata whenua of crafted taonga;

2.1.2. Requiring commercial use of taonga to be based on informed consent, genuine engagement, and reciprocity; and

2.1.3. Redesigning arts-related Government processes and support systems to be appropriate for Māori artists and arts practitioners.

3. Access to the Arts, Culture and Heritage

Issues

Access to arts, culture and heritage is growing, but uneven, with persistent gaps for rural communities, disabled people, and low-income households. Arts, culture and heritage are too often sidelined in education, in favour of other prioritised subjects, especially in under-resourced schools.

Actions

3.1. Ensure equitable access to all aspects of the arts, culture and heritage for marginalised communities, including by:

3.1.1. Resourcing marginalised communities to fully participate and lead in the sector, including through targeted funding and research;

3.1.2. Providing sustainable funding to inclusive community arts, culture and heritage organisations and those enabling access to the arts, culture and heritage; and

3.1.3. Implementing safety frameworks to support marginalised groups in arts spaces.

3.2. Support, promote and protect the arts of Pacific and other communities of colour, including by:

3.2.1. Developing and maintaining vocational pathways for tagata moana artists.

3.3. Ensure young people have access to appropriate arts training, both within and external to their schooling, including by:

3.3.1. Developing and resourcing the implementation of an ongoing arts education strategy from early childhood to tertiary level;

3.3.2. Provide secure funding for advisory services to schools in the performing arts, culture and screen arts;

3.3.3. Provide training to artists and other education providers to teach arts and cultural heritage to young people, and encourage young artists; and

3.3.4. Providing contestable funding for arts and cultural heritage organisations with a proven commitment to arts education, to cover operational and management expenses.

3.4. Encourage participation in and consumption of the arts, culture, and heritage, including by:

3.4.1. Resourcing regular community gatherings, festivals, and cultural events that bring communities together;

3.4.2. Developing a network of Art Spaces and heritage equivalents in every community that are accessible to all cultures and levels of ability, including programmes in prisons, and care and refuge spaces;

3.4.3. Supporting the purchase of artworks for public buildings, especially hospitals and schools, with an emphasis on locally-produced art;

3.4.4. Encouraging the therapeutic use of the arts in long-stay care, and rehabilitation facilities;

3.4.5. Supporting the heritage collections of public museums and art galleries as research and design resources for education, artistic, creative and community history projects through public access, robust care, and management; and

3.4.6. Supporting the purchase by public collecting institutions of nationally significant heritage objects and collections at risk of export.

4. Economic Development and the Arts, Culture, and Heritage

Issues

Creative industries make a significant economic contribution. Rising economic disparities, unstable income streams, and intergenerational knowledge gaps hinder creative start-ups and innovation. Reliance on corporate funding risks eroding artistic autonomy and public trust. Creative and cultural exporters face significant trade barriers, and there is a lack of scalable mid-size businesses.

Actions

4.1. Support the role of a high-quality arts, culture, and heritage sector in economic development, by:

4.1.1. Establishing an arts and cultural promotion unit within the Ministry of Foreign Affairs and Trade;

4.1.2. Funding research and development in the arts, culture, and heritage;

4.1.3. Incentivising private sector investment in projects and initiatives focused on the arts, culture, and/or heritage; and

4.1.4. Promoting local craft practitioners using local ingredients, recycling, and distributing products in sustainable ways.

4.2. Enable liveable incomes in the arts, culture, and heritage, by:

4.2.1. Establishing that copyright of a commissioned work is retained by the artist by default, not the commissioner, and that, when negotiated otherwise, copyright of a redistributable work reverts to the artist when the commissioner of a work ceases to distribute it; and

4.2.2. Ensure that the Public Lending Right provides adequate compensation to authors for the free public access New Zealanders have to their works through public libraries.

5. Protecting and Preserving our Heritage

Issues

There are significant challenges in protecting and preserving built heritage, including cost, seismic and climate risks, and pressures from urban development. Neglected buildings require expensive fixes to avoid demolition. Negative and systemic biases towards built and colonial heritage sideline and erode pre-colonial history, wāhi tapu, stories, and skills. Heritage losses are irreplaceable.

Actions

5.1. Strengthen heritage policy and funding by:

5.1.1. Establishing national direction for heritage, requiring local authorities to place more weight on recognising and supporting heritage places in district plans; and

5.1.2. Providing funding schemes for the maintenance and earthquake strengthening of privately-owned heritage buildings.

5.2. Enhance Māori and community leadership and engagement in heritage protection by:

5.2.1. Providing programmes that enable communities to safely explore the diversity and tensions in local heritage and traditions;

5.2.2. Increase the capacity of Te Papa's National Services to provide effective assistance, training and other services to local museums and art galleries in the care and management of heritage collections;

5.2.3. Prioritising areas of cultural value to communities, whānau, hapū and iwi when resourcing climate change adaptation; and

5.2.4. Resourcing artistic and community activities that seek to challenge entrenched harmful narratives and enhance understanding of a positive, sustainable and climate-safe future.